Tadeas Cely

Postdoctoral Researcher, Department of Political Science, Aarhus University

Address: Bartholins Allé 7, 1331, Aarhus, Midtjylland, 8000

Born: June, 1997

Email | Website | BlueSky | GitHub | ORCID

Academic Appointments

Aarhus University — Postdoctoral Researcher, Department of Political Science 2025–present

- Advertise Democracy Project (PI: Suthan Krishnarajan)
- APSA EPOVB Early-Career Fellow, 2025–2026
- Parental leave, January–March 2026

Visiting Positions

University of Zurich — Visiting Researcher, Department of Political Science 11-12/2024

- Dissertation research, host: *Simon Bornschier*
- Concurrent visit at *EUP Research Group*, ETH Zurich

Dartmouth College — Fulbright Fellow, Department of Government 9/2023–5/2024

- Affiliated with **Polarization Research Lab**, Dartmouth College, University of Pennsylvania and Stanford University, host: *Sean Westwood*

University of Vienna — Visiting Researcher, Department of Government 1-5/2023

- Dissertation research, host: *Markus Wagner*

Education

Masaryk University Brno — PhD in Political Science 2021–2025

- Dissertation: *Public Opinion Polarization in European Societies: When We Disagree and Why It Matters.*
- Committee: Noam Gidron (*Hebrew University of Jerusalem*), Filip Kostelka (*European University Institute*), Yphtach Lelkes (*University of Pennsylvania*)
- *Magna cum laude*; Vice-Rector's Award for Excellent PhD Students

MA in Political Science (Democracy and Human Rights), Masaryk University 2019–2021
BA in Political Science and History (double major), Masaryk University 2016–2019
Erasmus+ stay (French track), *Sciences Po Bordeaux* 2019

Publications

Ideology and Opinion Polarization

How ideological disagreement shapes affective reactions and how beliefs are structured and constrained across European countries and partisan camps.

Cely, Tadeas. 2026. "Hatred Takes an Ideologue: Recognizable Belief Patterns Lead to More Animosity and Disagreement." *Political Behavior* 48: 773–797.

Cely, Tadeas. 2025. "One More Constrained Than the Other: Asymmetrical Ideological Alignment and Its Implications for Polarization." *European Journal of Political Research* 64 (4): 1945–1973.

Cely, Tadeas. 2025. "New Threat of Culture Wars? The Religious Roots of Public Opinion Polarization on Morality Issues in Europe." *European Union Politics* 26 (2): 226–254. [*Jacques Rupnik Prize 2024*]

Democratic Backsliding

The role of voters and citizens in preventing backsliding, and interventions that help them safeguard democracy.

Cely, Tadeas, Marc S. Jacob, and Sean J. Westwood. 2026. "Levels of Office and Voter Accountability for Democratic Norm Violations." *Public Opinion Quarterly* 90 (2): 310–335.

Cely, Tadeas, Michal Tóth, Miroslav Nemčok, and Peter Spáč. "Democratic Cost of Politicizing Violent Events." *Revise & Resubmit* in *Journal of Peace Research.*

Comparative Political Behavior

Bringing the understudied countries of Central and Eastern Europe into the study of public opinion and political conflict.

Cely, Tadeas, and Andrew Roberts. 2026. "Signaling Good Practice: Trust in Political Science in Emerging Contexts." Forthcoming in *PS: Political Science & Politics.*

Hrbkova, Lenka, **Tadeas Cely**, and Matej Jungwirth. 2026. "Not Your Mama's Ideology (But Close): Modest Generational Differences in Ideological Alignment in Post-Communist Europe." *Public Opinion Quarterly* (Online First).

Toth, Michal, **Tadeas Cely**, and Roman Chytilek. 2025. "Facts Speak Louder? Comparing the Attention Effects of Moral and Factual Framing of Political Issues." *Electoral Studies* 98: 102996.

Selected Work in Progress

Cely, Tadeas. "Activating Ideology: Moralized Rhetoric Extends Partisan Conflict."

Cely, Tadeas. "Pragmatic versus Principled? Party Attachments and Policy Attitudes on Economic and Social Issues in Europe."

Eroglu, Melek Hilal, Tadeas Cely, and Suthan Krishnarajan. "Can Democracy Be Advertised? Evidence from a Large-Scale Experiment on Pro-Democracy Ads in the United States."

Cely, Tadeas, Lenka Hrbkova, and Matej Jungwirth. "Structures in Our Heads: Collective Identities and Partisan Alignment in Eastern Europe."

Grants and Fellowships

Total external funding attracted: ~30,000 EUR.

APSA EPOVB Early-Career Fellowship (1,000 USD) — 2025

Fulbright Fellowship (~27,700 USD) — 2023

AKTION Fellowship & PPSR Research Fund Award (2,300 + 3,000 EUR) — 2022

Travel Grants: Vrije Universiteit Brussel (2022), European Consortium for Political Research (2023), European University Institute (2024), University of Bergen (2025).

Invited Talks

University of Chicago, Quantitative Methods Workshop, Chicago — 2026

University of Oslo, Comparative Institutions and Regimes, Oslo — 2025

ETH Zurich, European Politics Colloquium, Zurich — 2024

University of Montreal Seminar Series, Montreal — 2024

University of Vienna Seminar Series, Vienna — 2023

Conference Presentations

2026. European Political Science Society, Belfast · Council for European Studies, Dublin · Elections, Public Opinion, and Voting Behavior (APSA), St. Louis · Danish Political Science Association, Nyborg

2025. Danish Political Science Association, Nyborg · International Society of Political Psychology, Prague · European Political Science Association, Madrid

2024. Czech Political Science Association, Usti n. L. · European Political Science Association, Cologne · Midwestern Political Science Association, Chicago — 2024

Workshops

2026. Global Democracy Conference, University of Notre Dame · Crisis of Democracy in Comparative Perspective, Aarhus University · 6th Annual Meeting, German Political Psychology Network, University of Vienna · Democratic Support: Preferences, Persuasion, and Resilience, LMU Munich (*co-convener*)

2025. EuroWEPS, University of Bergen · Brno Workshop on Consequences of Political Polarization (*co-convener*) · 5th Annual Meeting, German Political Psychology Network, University of Vienna

2023-2024. Political Behavior in Central and Eastern Europe Workshop, European University Institute (*2024*) · ECPR Joint Sessions: Networks of Political Beliefs, Toulouse (*2023*)

2022. NORFACE UNDPOLAR & POPBACK Conference, Brussels · ECPR Standing Group on Parliaments, Sciences Po, Paris

Teaching

Instructor of Record

Political Psychology of Ideology (*graduate*, expected), Aarhus University

Political Persuasion (*graduate*, 2026), Aarhus University, visiting lecturer (*undergraduate*, 2026), Masaryk University

Political Psychology (*graduate*, 2025, co-lecturing 50%), Masaryk University

Teaching Assistance

Masaryk University, Introduction to Political Science (2022, 2023); Contemporary Czech Politics (2022); History of Czech Politics (2023); Political Science Research Methods (2022); Statistical Reasoning in Political Science (2023).

Supervision: Reviewed 7 undergraduate theses, Masaryk University.

Service

Research Secretary (elected), Czech Political Science Association — 2022–2028

Main Convenor, Brno Workshop on Consequences of Political Polarization — 2024, one-day international workshop with 10 presentations from researchers across Austria, Czech Republic, Denmark, Italy, Spain, Turkey, and the United States.

Workshop Convenor, Doctoral Workshop in Political Research, Masaryk University — 2021–2024

Reviewer

Comparative Political Studies, *Democratization*, *Electoral Studies*, *European Societies*, *European Political Science Review*, *Network Science*, *Political Behavior*, *Public Opinion Quarterly*.

Non-Academic Writing and Engagement

"Europe's Culture Wars — Where People Disagree on Morality and Why." *LSE EUROPP Blog* (in English), 2025.

"Trust in the Social Sciences Doesn't Have to Be Lost: A New Study Shows How to Strengthen It." *Universitas* (in Czech), 2025.

"When We Disagree on Politics." *Bez Filtru* podcast (in Czech), 2025.

Skills

Tools and languages. R, LaTeX, Qualtrics, Python (beginner), JavaScript (beginner).

Languages. Czech/Slovak (native), English (CEFR C1), French (CEFR B2), German (beginner).

References

Suthan Krishnarajan. Associate Professor, Aarhus University. *suthan@ps.au.dk*

Sean Westwood. Associate Professor, Polarization Research Lab, Dartmouth College. *sean.j.westwood@dartmouth.edu*

Andrew Roberts. Professor, Northwestern University, Chicago. *aroberts@northwestern.edu*

Marc Jacob. Assistant Professor, University of Notre Dame. *smarc.jacob@nd.edu*

Isaac Mehlhaff. Neubauer Family Assistant Professor, University of Chicago. *imehlhaff@uchicago.edu*